

display with a screen resolution of 800*480 and a pixel density of 254 ppi. It also (strangely enough) featured a trackball which was for all purposes useless, as there was nothing in Android that could make use of it. On the inside, the Nexus One had a Qualcomm Snapdragon QSD8250 SoC with a Scorpion processor inside, coupled with 512 MB of RAM as well as 512 MB of onboard storage. The Nexus One was also the only Nexus phone to offer expandable storage upto 4 GB via micro SD card. It launched with Android 2.1 Eclair and was the first device to upgrade to Android 2.2 Froyo

The Nexus One generated genuine excitement prior to release, and was generally lauded once it was released. But then, once the novelty of a “Google Phone” wore off, it stopped selling. For starters, the \$529 asking price for an unlocked handset was truly astronomical, especially in 2010. Even on contract, \$179 was also a lot. Then the problems started. 3G connectivity was a hit or miss (so much that people filed lawsuits against Google) and the fact that it didn’t support multitouch was a huge miss. And then HTC citing AMOLED panel shortage issues, changed the screen to a super LCD screen. As several reviewers pointed out, it was a good and fast Android smartphone but the competition was simply better. And thus the hype failed.

• Nexus S

Breaking away from HTC after the Nexus One’s less than spectacular debut, Google turned to another behemoth in the Android smartphone business : Samsung. Not even a year after the launch of the Nexus One, Google announced the Nexus S on December 16th, 2010. Google seemed to want to keep unique design elements – make their phones a looker in other words, and the second Nexus phone didn’t disappoint on that front. It was totally familiar yet alien design at the same time, a slab of black plastic and glass with oddly sinuous curves that just felt right in the hand. It even managed to slim down a little to 10.8 mm and featured a 4 inch 800*480 screen with a pixel density of 233 ppi. Again due to AMOLED panel shortages, there were



Bears a striking resemblance to the Galaxy S